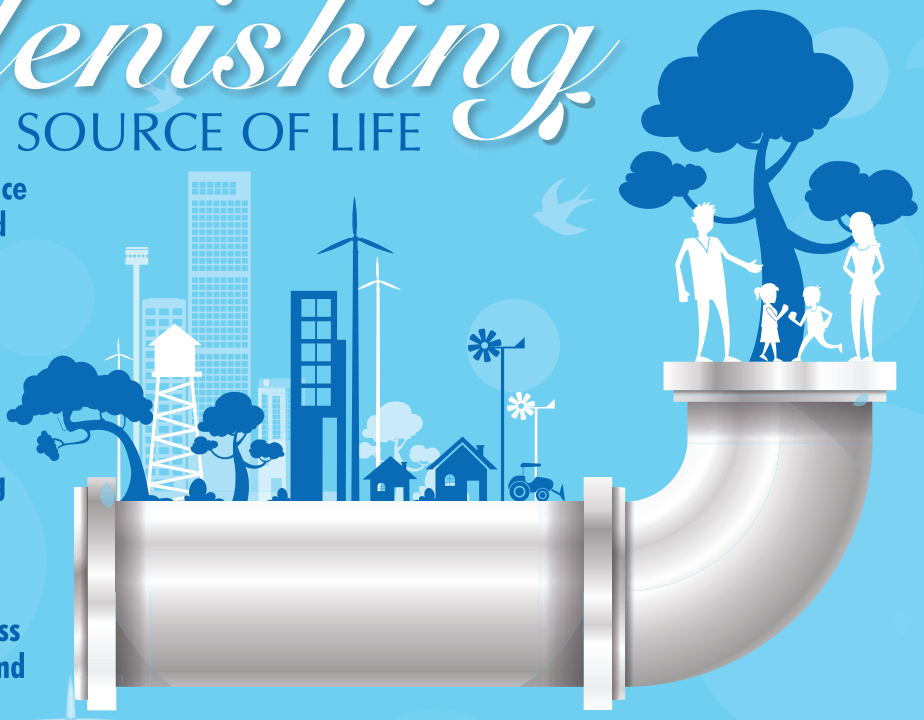
Replenishing
THE SOURCE OF LIFE



Water is the key to the existence of all living beings, plants and animals. However, due to increasing industrialisation, urbanisation, over-use and exploitation of natural sources, the earth is facing an acute shortage of water. Since water is an important building block of the existence of all living beings, every year 22 March is celebrated as World Water Day to spread awareness about the importance, need and conservation of water among the people. Let's take a look at the history and importance of World Water Day, as well as know about the theme of World Water Day 2022.

IMPORTANCE OF WORLD WATER DAY

Today, water crisis stares at the whole world. Water-borne diseases are on the rise due to the unavailability of clean and potable water. The objective of World Water Day is to ensure the availability of clean and safe potable water in all the countries of the world. It also focuses on the importance of water conservation.

Today, one in eight people in the world does not get pure water despite women and children spending hours collecting water from distant resources. The day provides an opportunity to remember our commitment to achieving the day when everyone in the world can have access to safe and clean water.

THEME OF THE WORLD WATER DAY 2022

This year's theme 'Groundwater: Making the Invisible Visible,' proposed by IGRAC i.e. International Groundwater Resource Assessment Centre, is dedicated to drawing attention to alarming depletion of groundwater in recent times. Groundwater is present in aquifers and saturated areas below the surface of the land. It is one of our most valuable resources, even though we never see or realise it is there. So, this year's theme is dedicated to making the invisible visible which necessitates sustainable use of this valuable resource and its protection from pollution.

Groundwater is a major, economical source of water for many rural populations and plays an important role in the development of these communities. Therefore, it is important to ensure that it is made available at an affordable cost or for free.

According to a report of the WaterAid, an international non-governmental organisation, focused on water, sanitation and hygiene, Indians use 24 percent of the total ground water in the world. The country receives an average rainfall of 1170 mm, but it is able to store only 6% of its water. Evidently, if the exploitation of groundwater is not stopped, the country may face a major water crisis.

HISTORY OF WORLD WATER DAY

In 1992, a resolution to celebrate the World Water Day was passed at the United Nations Conference on Environment and Development (UNCED) held in Rio de Janeiro, Brazil. The first World Water Day was organised on 22 March 1993. Since 1993, this day has been continued as an annual event to raise community awareness about understanding the importance of water conservation, and equitable management of this vital resource.

According to the UN website, the main objective of celebrating World Water Day is to "support the achievement of Sustainable Development Goal (SDG) 6: water and sanitation for all by 2030." The basic purpose is to urge the world to protect and manage this essential resource as without it human existence would be in danger.

Says Richard Connor, editor-in-chief of the United Nations' World Water Development Report, "Saving water might seem to be a small thing, but it is actually big when everybody does their part… when you are saving water, you are not just protecting the lake or the stream in your neighbourhood; you're doing much more than that for ecosystems, for the climate and for the planet."

The annual event of World Water Day aims to draw awareness about more than 2 billion people who are currently living without access to safe water. Millions of people get sick every year due to the use of dirty water in many countries of the world.

In some areas of sub-Saharan Africa and Southeast Asia, many people do not have safe water supplies. Another aspect of this crisis is sanitation, as an estimated 4 billion people do not have access to hygiene and sanitation facilities with more than 800 million people still defecating in the open – a figure that underscores that we need water. In fact, "clean water and sanitation for all" is one of 17 Sustainable Development Goals.